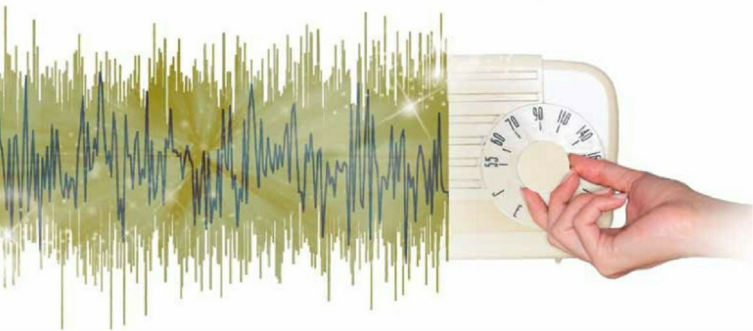


Performance Tuning and Monitoring

Part 1



The first article in this series introduces a few utilities that we can use to generate system hardware reports and plot the obtained data graphically using `gnuplot` and `MRTG`.

We generally use an OS in its native configuration—i.e., without bothering much about how the system will behave or respond in the current load situation. The overall load may vary from time to time, depending on the situation. So we need to continually monitor and tune our systems in the same manner like we change our car gears—depending upon the road and traffic conditions. Simply put, the objective of this series is to make Linux work more efficiently.

Performance tuning requires that you should have a sound knowledge of computer hardware—how the various computer components talk to each other, in addition to the various components of the operating

system. Collecting relevant data about a problem and analysing it is very important in successful performance tuning.

Let's start with some of the data gathering tools that can be used on Linux machines with kernel 2.6.x. The data gathered by these tools will then be used to analyse the problem, which will eventually lead to the solution.

Start with 'Beater Box'

Never consider performance tuning as some black art, with which you can give certain commands and your machine will start behaving just as you wanted it to. And never directly use all these labs/tools on a production server. Instead spare yourself a